

NITISH KUMAR PANDA

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Professional Summary

Level Designer & Environment Specialist with expertise in **Unreal Engine 5**. Specialized in creating immersive gameplay spaces with a focus on player flow, spatial storytelling, and technical optimization (Nanite, LODs, Lumen). Experienced in delivering high-quality stealth and co-op designs within professional studio pipelines.

Technical Skills

Engines: Unreal Engine 5 (Specialist), Unity
Level Design: Greyboxing/Whiteboxing, Combat Pacing, Player Flow, Spatial Puzzles, Navigation
Tech Art Pipeline: Optimization (Nanite, LODs), Lighting (Lumen, Volumetrics), Niagara VFX Basics
Game Design: GDD Documentation, Economy Loops, System Design, Progression Systems

Experience

Underdogs Studio (Mumbai) **Dec. 2025 – Present**
Remote

Level Designer (Confidential Co-op Project)

- Developing synchronized co-op puzzles requiring dual-player spatial coordination and communication.
- Managing split-path navigation to ensure balanced engagement for both players in professional loops.
- Collaborating with lead designers to align environmental flow with core studio objectives.

Akiyam (Gujarat) **Feb. 2023 – Jan. 2024**
Remote

Level Designer (Assassin: The First List - Steam Release)

- Designed and polished **4 full stealth levels** from blockout to high-fidelity final environments.
- Developed non-linear level architecture with strategic verticality for multiple gameplay approaches.
- Designed AI guard patrol routes and encounter positioning to maximize player tension.
- Utilized composition and lighting to ensure objective readability in professional environments.

Projects

3D Hustle | *Unreal Engine, Itch.io* **Jan. 2025**

- Lead Designer: Authored the complete **Game Design Document (GDD)** and core economy loops.
- Engineered progression systems and spatial navigation mechanics for a high-readability platformer.
- Optimized collision and platforming geometry to maintain player momentum and flow.

Psych Horror Prototype | *Unreal Engine, Lumen* **Dec. 2024**

- Designed an atmospheric horror level utilizing negative space and volumetric lighting.
- Controlled emotional pacing through claustrophobic spatial design and shadow-driven storytelling.

The Dyeing World | *Unreal Engine, 3D Platformer* **Oct. 2024**

- Used color-coded environment shapes to naturally guide player movement through exploration zones.

Santas Revenge (Game Jam) | *Unity, Arena Combat* **Dec. 2024**

- Designed a linear combat arena and enemy encounter pacing under a strict **48-hour deadline**.

Education

KIIT University **2019**
Master's Degree *Bhubaneswar, India*

Gamer2Maker **2024**
Game Design Certification *Online*